

# TEAM-Aligned Lesson Plan

U.S. History (Grades 9–12) · Franklin High School · Williamson County Schools

**Standard:** US.04 — Gilded Age Politics and Economics

**Schedule:** Regular block — 47 minutes · Date: \_\_\_\_\_ · Teacher: \_\_\_\_\_

**TN Standard (full text):** *Analyze the causes and consequences of Gilded Age politics and economics as well as the significance of the rise of political machines, major scandals, civil service reform, and the economic difference between farmers, wage earners, and industrial capitalists, including: Boss Tweed, Thomas Nast, Credit Mobilier, Spoils system and President James A. Garfield's assassination, Pendleton Act, Interstate Commerce Act.*

## 1 · Standards & Objectives

**Learning objective (I-CAN):** “I can analyze the causes and consequences of Gilded Age politics and economics, including political machines, major scandals, civil service reform, and economic differences between farmers, wage earners, and industrial capitalists.”

**Sub-objectives (sequenced from the standard's criteria):**

- Political Machines and Boss Tweed.
- Major Scandals and the Spoils System.
- Civil Service Reform.

**Connection to prior learning:** Builds on US.03 (Compromise of 1877, Jim Crow & Plessy v. Ferguson) — students carry yesterday's understanding into today's standard.

**Tennessee connection:** Tennessee politics during the Gilded Age reflected national patterns of corruption and reform. Memphis boss Edward Hull Crump built one of the South's most powerful political machines, dominating Memphis and Shelby County politics from the early 1900s through the 1950s.

## 2 · Assessment & Evidence of Mastery

**Measured in multiple ways (TEAM: 3+ measures with clear criteria):**

- **Selected-response + short constructed:** US.04 Formative Assessment (with teacher answer key).
- **Extended writing:** CER organizer — claim, evidence, reasoning on the Gilded Age Politics and Economics.
- **Primary-source analysis:** HIPP organizer on “Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act” (U.S. Congress, January 16, 1883).
- **Exit ticket (EN + ES):** 2-question check for understanding, bilingual.

**Success criteria:** Student cites at least two specific pieces of evidence and can analyze the causes and consequences of Gilded Age politics and economics, including political machines, major scandals, civil service reform, and economic differences between farmers, wage earners, and industrial capitalists.

## 3 · Lesson Structure & Pacing (47-minute Regular block)

| Min | Segment & what happens                                                                                                                                             | Material                                     |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 5   | Warm-Up / Bell-Ringer — recall Compromise of 1877, Jim Crow & Plessy v. Ferguson (US.03); frame today's question                                                   | Guided Notes (Do-Now box)                    |
| 4   | Hook — Tennessee politics during the Gilded Age reflected national patterns of corruption and reform: Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter? | Teacher Deck                                 |
| 12  | Direct Instruction — teacher models close reading of the core content; students capture guided notes                                                               | Teacher Deck + Guided Notes                  |
| 10  | Guided Practice — Cornell Notes + a comparison/analysis organizer                                                                                                  | Cornell Notes · organizer                    |
| 11  | Primary Source / HIPP — analyze the source; begin CER                                                                                                              | Primary-Source Packet · HIPP · CER organizer |
| 5   | Exit Ticket & Closure — 2-question check; preview US.05                                                                                                            | Exit Ticket (EN/ES)                          |

Total: 47 minutes (segments sum-verified to the block length; auto-adjusts to 43-min Activities or 41-min Late-Start).

## 4 · Activities & Materials (teacher-selected)

- Guided Notes — scaffolded direct-instruction capture
- Cornell Notes — cue/notes/summary for retention
- Comparison / analysis organizer — structure student thinking on the core content
- Primary-Source Packet + HIPP organizer — sourcing & analysis of “Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act”
- CER organizer — evidence-based extended writing
- Formative Assessment + Exit Ticket (EN/ES) — checks for understanding

**Word Bank (key vocabulary):** Gilded Age · Political Machines · Spoils System · Boss Tweed · Thomas Nast · Pendleton Act

*Complex text, student choice (organizer format), primary sources, and student-to-student discussion are built in — satisfying the TEAM Activities & Materials indicators.*

## 5 · Questioning Plan (DOK ladder, text-based, cite evidence)

| Level | Example question (US.04)                                                                                                      |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DOK 1 | Define the key term “Gilded Age” and identify when it occurred.                                                               |
| DOK 2 | In your own words, summarize the Gilded Age Politics and Economics and explain why it mattered.                               |
| DOK 3 | Analyze the economic relationship between farmers, railroads, and industrial capitalists during the Gilded Age.               |
| DOK 4 | Evaluate the long-term impact of the Gilded Age Politics and Economics — support your claim with evidence from the source(s). |

*Anchored to the US.04 content and item bank (DOK 1–4). Majority of questions are text-based; students cite evidence. Teacher may swap in additional bank items.*

## 6 · Thinking & Problem-Solving

- **Analytical thinking:** compare and contrast perspectives within the Gilded Age Politics and Economics.
- **Research-based thinking:** evaluate “Pendleton Civil Service Reform Act” and related sources.
- **Problem-solving (drawing conclusions / justifying):** students build and defend a claim in the CER.

## 7 · Grouping & Feedback [teacher selects]

- **Grouping:** pairs for the CER organizer; whole-class for the primary-source model; individual exit ticket.
- **Feedback checkpoints:** circulate during Guided Practice and Primary-Source segments; use exit-ticket results to adjust tomorrow's opening.

## 8 · Differentiation (Knowledge of Students)

- **ELL / WIDA:** UDL/WIDA overlay + sentence frames; Spanish exit ticket for entering/emerging levels.
- **IEP / 504:** chunked guided notes, extended time, read-aloud (browser TTS), reduced-item formative option.

## 9 · Environment Reminders (teacher-implemented)

*A lesson plan supports — but cannot manufacture — the TEAM Environment domain. Reminders:*

- Set high expectations; frame content with dignity and historical accuracy.
- Establish discussion norms before the primary-source analysis.
- Display current student work; keep materials accessible for the pair activity.

## 10 · Materials & Where to Print

**Included in today's print ZIP** (US.04 — print-ready PDF + editable DOCX):

| Student (print & copy)          | Teacher (your copy)               |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Guided Notes                    | Teacher Lesson Plan (this doc)    |
| Cornell Notes                   | Formative Assessment — Answer Key |
| Comparison / analysis organizer | Primary-Source Teacher Guide      |

| Student (print & copy)          | Teacher (your copy)    |
|---------------------------------|------------------------|
| CER organizer                   | UDL / WIDA overlay     |
| HIPP organizer                  | File Map & Print Guide |
| Primary-Source Packet           |                        |
| Formative Assessment            |                        |
| Exit Ticket — English & Spanish |                        |

**Slides (download once for the unit):**

Unit 1 Teacher Deck — US.04 slides. Download from Teacher Tools → Lecture Decks → Unit 1. (Decks are reused all unit, so they are not bundled in the daily ZIP.)

**11 · Reflection & Next Steps****Teacher reflection (complete after teaching):**

- Did students meet the I-CAN? Cite the evidence — exit-ticket % correct, CER quality.
- What worked, and what would I change next time?
- Which sub-objective still needs another touch tomorrow?

**Extension / enrichment** (for students who mastered it):

- Deeper source work: analyze a second primary source with the HIPP organizer.
- Connect forward: how does the Gilded Age Politics and Economics set up US.05 (Inventions & Innovations of Business Leaders & Entrepreneurs)?

**If it's not working** (reteach / intervention path):

- Below ~70% mastery on the exit ticket / formative → reteach with entry-tier materials (guided notes + a shorter source) in a small group — MTSS Tier 2.
- **One click — “Remediate US.04”:** assembles a reteach pack (entry-tier worksheet, targeted DOK 1–2 questions, ELL/IEP supports) as a fresh print ZIP.
- **Mid-lesson trouble:** if pacing slips, protect the 5-min Exit Ticket — it's tomorrow's data — and move the CER to homework or the next day.

**Appendix · How this plan maps to the TEAM rubric**

| TEAM indicator                       | Where addressed                                          |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Standards & Objectives               | §1 — I-CAN + sequenced sub-objectives + prior learning   |
| Motivating Students                  | §3 Hook — Tennessee relevance                            |
| Presenting Content                   | §3 DI — deck visuals + guided notes + modeling           |
| Lesson Structure & Pacing            | §3 — 47-min segmented, warm-up → closure                 |
| Activities & Materials               | §4 — varied, choice, primary sources, complex text       |
| Questioning                          | §5 — DOK 1–4 ladder, text-based, cite evidence           |
| Feedback                             | §7 — checkpoints during guided practice                  |
| Grouping                             | §7 — pairs + whole-class + individual                    |
| Teacher Content Knowledge            | §1/§4 — accurate, standards-aligned content              |
| Knowledge of Students                | §8 — UDL/WIDA + IEP/504                                  |
| Thinking / Problem-Solving           | §6 — analytical, research-based, justify a claim         |
| <b>PLANNING: Instructional Plans</b> | Whole plan — sequenced, accommodations, closure          |
| <b>PLANNING: Student Work</b>        | §2 — CER + HIPP extended writing                         |
| <b>PLANNING: Assessment</b>          | §2 — multiple measures + clear criteria                  |
| Environment (3 indicators)           | §9 — reminders (teacher-implemented; not auto-generated) |

The three **PLANNING** indicators (highlighted) are what a written plan is directly scored on — this template earns them structurally. The Instruction indicators are documented so the teacher walks in ready; the Environment domain is prompted, not generated.